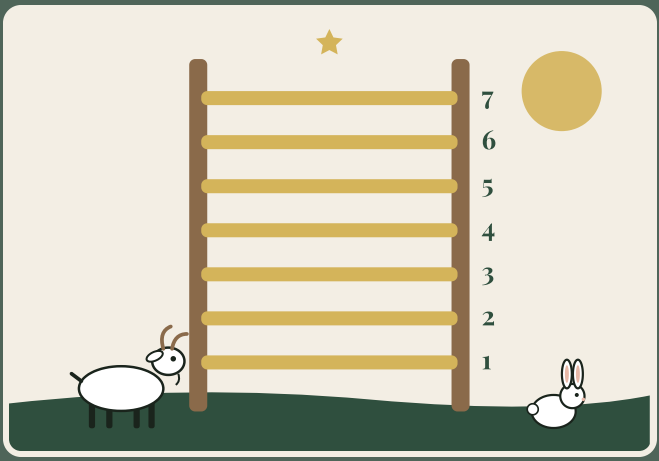
A PICTURE BOOK FROM YOUR CFO · OCTOBER 30, 2026

Once you have this, *you get that.*

Sheehan Homestead

Seven rungs, in order. Each one pays for the next. Skip a rung and the ladder wobbles. Climb them in order and every step gets cheaper, safer and easier to sell.



FROM YOUR CFO

Here is how I read your business. You were careful on purpose: goats and bunnies, no horses, no cows, because feed, vet, insurance and a trailer cost real money and a pony can step on a foot. That was the right call. This book is the plan for when each bigger thing gets safe to say yes to.

1 **Basic insurance**
Your first pony. The paper every venue asks for.

2 **Next level compliance**
Licenses, helper standards, waivers, vehicle. The big contracts open.

3 **Payroll**
Real W-2 paychecks for both founders. A history banks can read.

4 **Benefits**
Health and retirement that keep good people.

5 **Credit and financing**
Business credit and SBA loans on clean books.

6 **Trailer, then the pony**
Bigger gear and bigger animals, bought with a loan, not a card.

7 **The RV**
A rolling classroom and glamping at the top of the ladder.

Paperwork is a sales tool. Every rung you climb is something a backyard competitor can't copy fast, and something a CDD, school, sponsor or lender checks before they say yes.

START HERE

Rung 1: *basic insurance.*

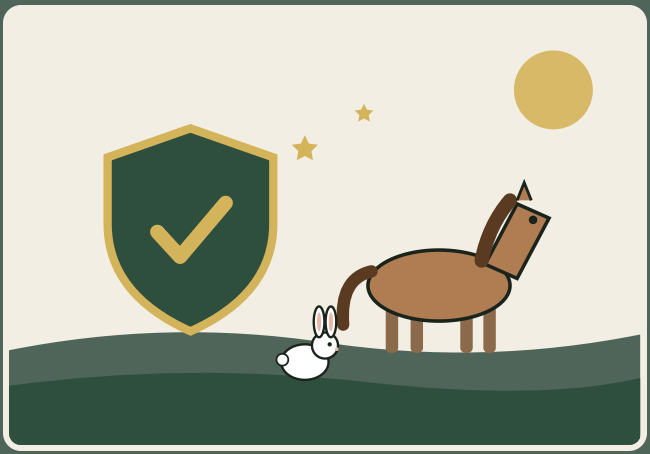
Plain words on every page. Sources on the last page.

Sheehan Homestead

RUNG 1 OF 7 · BASIC INSURANCE

Basic insurance is your first pony. *Once you have it, you get to say yes.*

Every CDD, school and senior community asks for one page before anything else: proof of insurance. No proof, no gig. This rung pays for every rung above it.



FROM YOUR CFO

Ask one question in writing. Pull the declarations page of your current policy and ask the carrier: does this cover animals meeting the public, including illnesses passed from animals? If the answer is no, this is the first check you write.

PLAIN WORDS

General liability
Pays if a guest gets hurt or something gets damaged at your event.

Care, custody or control
Covers animals or property in your care that belong to someone else. Plain liability often leaves this out.

Animal exhibitor coverage
Liability written for animals meeting the public. Many ordinary policies exclude animal contact and illnesses passed from animals to people.

Certificate of insurance
The one page proof a venue asks for. "Additional insured" means the venue's name rides on your policy for that event.

Umbrella
Extra coverage stacked on top of your other policies for a big claim.

WHAT IT COSTS

ITEM	RANGE FOUND
Animal contact petting zoo liability, starting quote packet (Stratum, Feb 2026)	$2.5k to $3k/yr
Animal contact liability minimums, specialty carriers (research, not a quote)	$2k to $3k/yr
Commercial umbrella, $1M (research, not a quote)	$500 to $1.2k/yr

Ranges come from your inbox and Sept 28 research notes. Get two written quotes before you buy.

ONCE YOU HAVE THIS, YOU GET

- Certificates on demand for CDDs, HOAs and schools
- Venues named as additional insured in minutes
- Bigger corporate and festival contracts
- The pony conversation starts here: no carrier writes a pony without this base

NEXT RUNG

Rung 2: *next level compliance.*

Sources for every number are on the last page. Have your CPA, agent or lawyer confirm before you spend.

Sheehan Homestead

RUNG 2 OF 7 · NEXT LEVEL COMPLIANCE

Once you're compliant, *you get the big contracts.*

Enterprise buyers check paperwork before they check prices. Clean paperwork is the moat. It is the first thing reporters, competitors and franchise buyers look at.



FROM YOUR CFO

Settle the USDA question first. Run USDA's free online Licensing Assistant with your real headcount of animals. It takes minutes, and it is the number one thing a reporter or a competitor checks.

PLAIN WORDS

USDA exhibitor license (Class C)
The federal license for showing animals to the public. USDA says petting zoos with regulated animals need one. Exempt: only farm animals at agricultural fairs, or 8 or fewer animals kept for exhibition. A Standard zoo brings 9 or more.

FWC permits
Florida wildlife permits. Needed for captive wildlife and exotic species, not for domestic goats, bunnies or chickens.

Health certificate (OCVI)
A vet's signed health paper. Florida wants one within 90 days, plus official ID, for goats at an exhibition.

Business tax receipt
The local license to do business. Nassau County dropped its county receipt for unincorporated areas. A town may still require one inside its limits.

1099 contractor
Someone who runs their own work and gets a 1099 form, not a paycheck. The IRS looks at who controls how the work gets done.

THE COMPLIANCE CHECKLIST

- **Helper standards in writing.** Helpers accept or decline each gig. Flat rate per gig, posted before they accept. You set the result, they bring their skill. Collect a W-9 before the first payout.
- **1099 forms.** For payments made in 2026, file a 1099-NEC for anyone you pay $2,000 or more in the year (it was $600).
- **Waivers** signed at check in, with property rules spelled out. Have your lawyer review the wording.
- **Vehicle.** Personal auto policies often exclude business use. Ask your agent for commercial auto on anything that hauls animals.
- **Sunbiz annual report** by May 1. **Sales tax** registration if you sell admissions or merchandise.
- **Animal Control permit** kept current, and the farm's operating record documented.

ONCE YOU HAVE THIS, YOU GET

- CDD, school and corporate vendor approval on the first try
- Sponsor checks with your name on the season
- Press without surprises
- A clean file for a franchise disclosure later

NEXT RUNG

Rung 3: *payroll.*

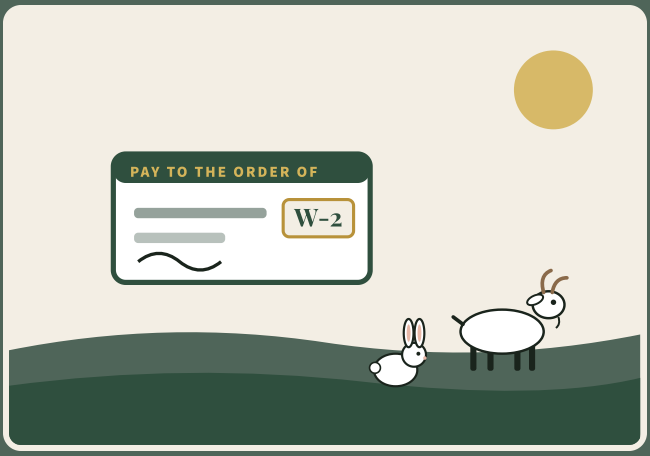
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Sheehan Homestead

RUNG 3 OF 7 · PAYROLL

Once you have payroll, *you get a paycheck a bank believes.*

Lenders don't lend on hustle. They lend on W-2s and tax returns. Payroll turns the money you already earn into a history a bank can read, starting with the first paycheck in January 2027.



FROM YOUR CFO

Pick cheap and boring. Patriot Full Service files your taxes for about $47 a month for two people. Gusto is the smoothest app at $61. Either one does the job. Start it in January and never miss a run.

PLAIN WORDS

W-2
The wage form an employee gets each year. It shows a lender steady income.

S corporation election (Form 2553)
A tax choice for the LLC. Owners take a fair salary through payroll and the rest as distributions. For a Jan 1, 2027 start, file by Mar 15, 2027.

Reasonable compensation
Pay yourself close to what you would pay someone else to do your job. Never zero salary while taking distributions.

Reemployment tax (RT-6)
Florida's unemployment tax. New employers pay 2.7% on the first $7,000 of each person's wages. Florida has no state income tax.

Workers' comp
Pays for on the job injuries. Florida requires it at 4 or more employees outside construction. LLC members count unless they file an exemption.

PAYROLL THAT FILES YOUR TAXES · LIST PRICE, 2 PEOPLE PAID

PROVIDER AND PLAN	BASE + PER PERSON	2 PEOPLE/MO
Patriot Full Service	$37 + $5	$47
Wave Payroll	$40 + $6	$52
Gusto Simple (one state)	$49 + $6	$61
OnPay Payroll Essentials	$49 + $6	$61
QuickBooks Workforce Payroll	$50 + $7	$64
ADP RUN Essential	Quote only	ask

Checked Oct 30, 2026 on each provider's page, before promos. ADP publishes no price; outside guides report about $79 + $4. Wave's tax service excludes 1099 filings.

ONCE YOU HAVE THIS, YOU GET

- Real W-2 salaries for both founders
- The two year income history lenders want
- Clean owner health premiums through payroll
- Helpers moved to W-2 when the steady hours are there, with workers' comp at 4

NEXT RUNG

Rung 4: *benefits.*

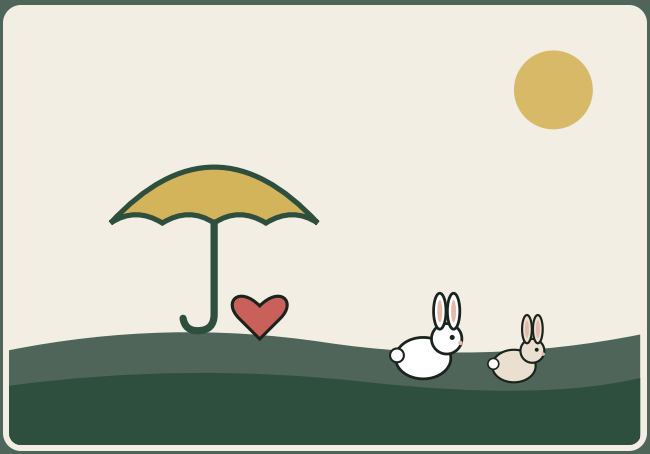
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Sheehan Homestead

RUNG 4 OF 7 · BENEFITS

Once payroll runs, *you get benefits that keep good people.*

Benefits are how a small farm keeps the helper who already knows every goat by name. They also lower the tax bill on money you would spend anyway.



FROM YOUR CFO

Owners first, staff second. Run your own premiums through payroll the day payroll starts. Add a QSEHRA or ICHRA the day your first non owner goes on W-2. Pick Solo 401(k) while it's just you two, SIMPLE IRA once helpers join.

PLAIN WORDS

Owner health premiums
The business pays your health premiums, they show on your W-2 as wages without payroll tax, and you deduct them on your return. Spouses count together as more than 2% owners.

QSEHRA
A monthly allowance that repays staff for their own health premiums. For employers under 50 people with no group plan. 2026 caps: $6,450 single, $13,100 family.

ICHRA
The same idea with no dollar cap, and it grows with you. Neither is tax free for more than 2% owners.

SIMPLE IRA
An easy retirement plan for small employers. 2026: employees save up to $17,000, plus $4,000 more at 50 and over. You match up to 3%.

Solo 401(k)
A retirement plan for owners and spouses only, with no other employees. 2026 savings limit: $24,500.

YOUR EDGE ON THIS RUNG

- You come from enterprise architecture and compliance software. You already know how to map red tape and sell it. Use that here.
- If you sit the Enrolled Agent exam (the IRS tax credential), the testing window you noted closes Feb 28, 2027.
- Small group health plans in Florida usually need at least one non owner on W-2. Owner only groups often get declined.
- Put every benefit choice in a one page board resolution. Lenders and investors like seeing it.

ONCE YOU HAVE THIS, YOU GET

- Helpers who stay, and a crew you can train once
- Lower taxes on money you spend anyway
- A real offer when you recruit
- A business that looks like a company to investors

NEXT RUNG

Rung 5: *credit and financing.*

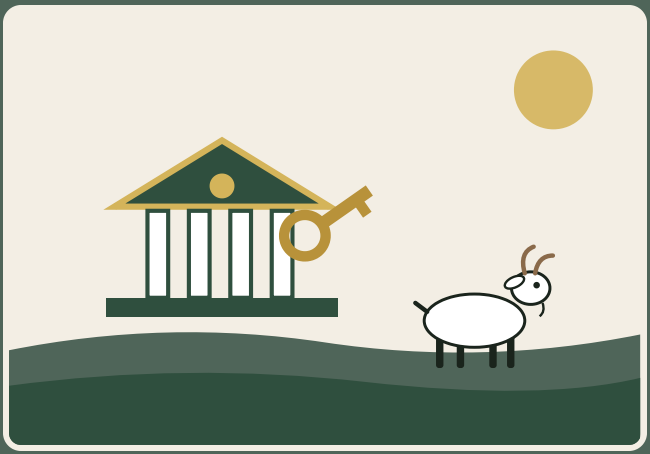
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RUNG 5 OF 7 · CREDIT AND FINANCING

Once the books are clean, *you get to borrow on your terms.*

Cards and cash advances are expensive money. Clean books plus payroll history unlock cheap money: business credit and SBA loans.



FROM YOUR CFO

Separate the money this month. One business account, one business card, books reconciled every month. That single habit decides whether a banker reads your file in ten minutes or never.

PLAIN WORDS

Business credit
A credit file in the company's name, separate from yours. It starts with an EIN, a business bank account, a free D-U-N-S number and vendor accounts that report.

SBA 7(a) loan
A bank loan the government partly guarantees, so the bank says yes more often. Up to $5 million. SBA guarantees 85% up to $150,000 and 75% above that.

Loan term
How long you get to repay. 7(a) loans run up to 10 years, and up to 25 years for real estate.

Clean books
Every dollar in its own account, reconciled monthly. No personal spending on the business card.

Two year history
Mortgage lenders usually want two years of personal and business returns from owners of 25% or more.

WHAT A LENDER READS

- Two years of tax returns and W-2 history, starting January 2027
- Reconciled books in QuickBooks, Wave or Patriot
- Proof you can repay: steady bookings, standing subscriptions, sponsors
- No surprise liens or court records. Check the county records before you apply.
- SBA also wants a for profit U.S. business that meets size rules and can't get the same credit elsewhere on fair terms

ONCE YOU HAVE THIS, YOU GET

- Trailer and equipment loans instead of cards
- A line of credit for slow months
- A clean file for investors and the holding company
- The next rung: bigger gear and bigger animals

NEXT RUNG

Rung 6: *the trailer, then the pony.*

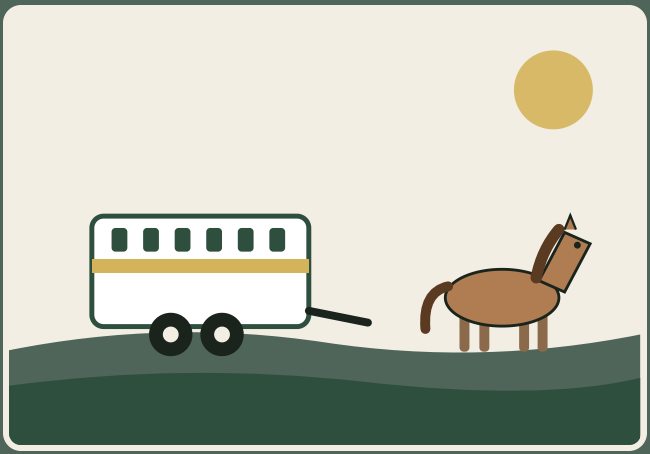
Sources for every number are on the last page. Have your CPA, agent or lawyer confirm before you spend.

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RUNG 6 OF 7 · BIGGER ANIMALS AND GEAR

Once you can borrow, *you get the trailer, then the pony.*

Bigger animals mean bigger feed, vet and insurance bills, plus the rig to haul them. Your own rule stays: no purchase until the county and the insurance agent both say yes in writing.



FROM YOUR CFO

Trailer first, pony second. The trailer earns on every gig you already sell. The pony only earns once it is insured, papered and trailered. Quote both insurance options, petting and rides, before you ever look at a pony.

PLAIN WORDS

Equipment loan
A loan secured by the thing you buy. The trailer pays for itself over the loan term instead of sitting on a card.

USDOT number
A federal carrier ID. Florida requires one for in state commercial rigs at 26,001 pounds or more. Stay under that and you skip it.

CDL
A commercial driver's license. A Class A is needed when the truck and trailer weigh 26,001 pounds or more and the trailer alone tops 10,000 pounds.

Coggins test
A blood test for equine infectious anemia. Florida requires a negative test within 12 months to move a horse or bring it to an event.

Equine liability
Insurance for horses and ponies. Pony rides need a separate operator policy that costs more than a pony that is only petted.

THE ORDER OF YES

- **1. Zoning.** Nassau County confirms the animals are allowed on the parcel.
- **2. Insurance in writing.** An equine rider or a specialty policy, bound before the animal arrives.
- **3. Health papers.** Coggins on file, vet plan, farrier, fencing and shelter quoted.
- **4. The rig.** Trailer bought on an equipment loan, kept under the weight lines above.
- **5. The pony.** Petting first. Rides only after the operator policy and handler training.
- Horses aren't covered by the USDA exhibitor license, but goats and bunnies still are.

ONCE YOU HAVE THIS, YOU GET

- More animals per gig and a premium tier to sell
- Festival and fair contracts that ask for a pony
- Hauling on your own schedule
- And until then: if you ever want a great time without a horse, call us

NEXT RUNG

Rung 7: *the RV.*

Sources for every number are on the last page. Have your CPA, agent or lawyer confirm before you spend.

Sheehan Homestead

RUNG 7 OF 7 · THE TOP OF THE LADDER

At the top, *you get the RV.*

A rolling STEM classroom for schools and events, and glamping at the homestead for families who want to stay the night. It is the last rung because it needs every rung below it.



FROM YOUR CFO

Buy it with cash flow or an equipment loan, never with hope. The RV comes after payroll has run for a while and the books are clean, so a lender pays for most of it and the gigs pay the lender.

PLAIN WORDS

Mobile classroom
An RV fitted for hands on STEM lessons that parks at a school or event. STEM on Call on wheels.

Glamping
Comfortable camping for guests at the farm. That makes you a lodging business, with its own rules.

Short term rental rules
County licensing, tourist tax and occupancy limits for paid overnight guests.

Habitational insurance
Coverage for people sleeping on your property. Farm policies often exclude paid stays.

Commercial RV coverage
An RV used for business needs a business policy. A personal RV policy usually won't cover paid work.

BEFORE THE KEYS

- Nassau County short term rental license and tourist tax before any paid overnight guest
- Septic capacity, setbacks and fire access checked for trailers or RVs used as stays
- Insurance bindable in writing before you list a single night
- Keep guests and worker housing separate. If housing is part of anyone's pay, ask your CPA first.
- Check the weight: at 26,001 pounds and up, Florida's commercial vehicle rules start

ONCE YOU HAVE THIS, YOU GET

- Two more products: rolling STEM lessons and farm stays
- Bigger school and district contracts
- A visible brand on every road you drive
- A business that looks like a franchise, ready for On Call Brands

NEXT RUNG

Last page: *sources and the side list.*

Sources for every number are on the last page. Have your CPA, agent or lawyer confirm before you spend.

Sheehan Homestead

THE LAST PAGE

Also on the list, *and where every number came from.*

Sheehan Homestead

Rules and prices change. Every figure in this book was read from the source below on Oct 30, 2026, or pulled from your own files where noted. Your CPA, insurance agent and lawyer get the final word before you spend.

SIDE RUNGS YOU'VE NAMED

- **S corp election** for the LLC, effective Jan 1, 2027. File Form 2553 now; keep the IRS acceptance letter.
- **I-9 and Florida new hire report** for every W-2 employee, owners included.
- **On Call Brands** holding company for the brands and IP. Entity type set with your CPA. Family keeps at least 50.1%.
- **Email rules (CAN-SPAM).** Physical address and an unsubscribe link on batch email. A business line on public listings, not a personal cell.
- **Exotics.** Species list, then permit path, then an insurance quote. No animal until all three.
- **Dog boarding** waits for money and insurance, same as the pony.

SOURCES

Insurance. Stratum Insurance quote packet email, Feb 24, 2026 (in your inbox). Sept 28, 2026 insurance research notes in your records. Florida DFS small business insurance guide: myfloridacfo.com

USDA exhibitor license. USDA APHIS, Licensing and Registration Under the Animal Welfare Act (aphis.usda.gov/sites/default/files/graybook.pdf); 9 CFR 2.1(a)(3)(vii), 8 or fewer animals (ecfr.gov); USDA Licensing Assistant: efile.aphis.usda.gov/LRAssistant

Goat health papers. FDACS Goat Movement Requirements and Fla. Admin. Code 5C-4.005 (fdacs.gov)

FWC. FWC captive wildlife permits (myfwc.com/license/captive-wildlife)

Local license. Nassau County Business/Occupational Licenses (nassaucountyfl.com/833)

1099 and contractors. IRS: Am I required to file a Form 1099; Instructions for Forms 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC (2026), $2,000 threshold for payments after Dec 31, 2025; IRS Independent contractor or employee (irs.gov)

Workers' comp. Florida DFS Division of Workers' Compensation, Coverage Requirements and Non Construction Exemptions (myfloridacfo.com/division/wc)

Payroll prices. gusto.com/product/pricing; patriotsoftware.com/payroll/pricing; waveapps.com/payroll; onpay.com/pricing ($49 base + $6/worker); quickbooks.intuit.com/online/starting-up/payroll; ADP has no public RUN price (adp.com), estimate via tech.co. All read Oct 30, 2026.

S corp and payroll tax. IRS Instructions for Form 2553; IRS S Corporation Compensation and Medical Insurance Issues; IRS Pub 15; Florida DOR Reemployment Tax (floridarevenue.com)

Benefits. IRS Notice 2008-1 (2% shareholder health); IRS Notice 2017-67 (QSEHRA) and 2026 limits; ICHRA final rule 84 FR 28888; IRS: 401(k) limit increases to $24,500 for 2026; IRS COLA table (SIMPLE $17,000)

Credit. SBA 7(a) loans (sba.gov/loans/7a-loans); SBA SOP 50 10 8.1; Fannie Mae Selling Guide B3-3.2 (selling-guide.fanniemae.com); Dun & Bradstreet D-U-N-S

Trailer, pony, RV. FLHSMV Florida USDOT Numbers (flhsmv.gov); Fla. Stat. 316.302; FMCSA Do I need a USDOT number and CDL classes (fmcsa.dot.gov); FDACS Equine Movement Requirements and Fla. Admin. Code 5C-18.010 (Coggins)

Your own files. S corp compliance checklist (Oct 15, 2026); compliance roadmap (Sept 23, 2026); core mission (Oct 22, 2026); investor deck v6 notes

YOUR CFO'S LAST WORD

Climb in order. ***Each rung pays for the next.***

Sheehan Homestead LLC · Critters on Call · STEM on Call · Callahan, FL · sheehanhomestead.com

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